

Teaching Statement

Since graduating from high school, I have spent the past decade pursuing higher education. In that process, I was fortunate to learn from several inspiring teachers. As my learning need as a student evolved, I became more mindful of not only what was being taught but also how it was taught. These observations and my own experiences within the classroom have profoundly shaped my own teaching philosophy. I view economics as one of the most versatile disciplines because it provides us the tools to understand many of the choices, institutions, and constraints that shape our material world. Therefore, as an instructor, I believe it is essential to be methodical in helping students build a strong foundation in economic thinking. I aim to create a structured and inclusive classroom environment where students can develop deep conceptual understanding, improve the ability to connect theory with practice, hone their problem-solving skills and learn to collaborate and communicate with confidence.

To put these goals into practice, I plan to use a combination of teaching methods that allows students to engage with course material in different ways. I will combine clear lectures and accessible slides with diagrams, practical examples, and step-by-step board work. I will also provide supporting materials that students can review outside class. Also, I will regularly work through problems in class and invite students to explain their reasoning. For example, when introducing opportunity cost, I might ask students how they would allocate a free afternoon among studying, working, resting, or spending time with family and friends. We would use their choices to identify the next-best alternative they gave up and then connect the discussion to the broader economic problem of allocating limited resources. I will use examples that do not assume that all students share the same cultural, financial, or educational background.

My experience as a teaching assistant has shown me that students also need meaningful support outside the classroom. While assisting instructors, I held office hours twice each week, and these sessions were consistently well attended. Students came before exams to clarify concepts and work through practice problems, as well as afterward to understand their mistakes. When several students shared the same question, I used the board to review the underlying concept and solve a representative problem step by step before addressing individual concerns. I also asked students to explain where they became confused so that I could focus on the specific gap in their understanding and use our limited time effectively. As an instructor, I will continue to maintain regular office hours, make myself available by appointment when possible, and encourage students to contact me by email whenever they need clarification or additional guidance.

I intend to evaluate student learning using different forms of assessment rather than relying on a single measure. Low-stakes quizzes will help students identify gaps in their understanding, while take-home problem sets will give them regular practice applying economic concepts and mathematical tools. Data assignments may ask students to interpret regression results, create graphs, or use real-world evidence to answer an economic question. Exams will include a combination of conceptual questions, calculations, graphical analysis, and short written responses so that students can demonstrate both technical ability and economic reasoning. Group projects and presentations will allow students to collaborate, communicate their findings, and apply course material to a practical question. In graduate courses, I would also ask students to evaluate published research, identify unanswered questions, and develop a research proposal or agenda of their own.

My central goal as a teacher is to make the process of learning unfamiliar concepts as clear and manageable as possible. Economics often asks students to think in new ways, and I do not want a student's initial difficulty with a model, graph, or mathematical method to discourage them from engaging with the subject. By breaking difficult material into smaller steps, explaining ideas in more than one way, and making room for questions, I hope to ensure that students feel supported while still being challenged.

I take student evaluations and feedback seriously because my teaching methods should respond to the needs of the students. I will use their feedback, along with what I observe in assignments, exams, and office hours, to identify concepts that need to be explained differently or covered at a different pace. My experience as a teaching assistant for a range of undergraduate courses has prepared me to support students across diverse areas and levels of economics. At the undergraduate level, I have served as a teaching assistant for Principles of Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Labor Economics, Economics of Human Rights, and International Economics. At the graduate level, I have served as a teaching assistant for Advanced Econometrics. I am prepared to teach broadly across the undergraduate economics curriculum, with particular interest in Principles of Microeconomics, Labor Economics, and Applied Econometrics. At the graduate level, I would be interested in teaching Advanced Econometrics and Labor Economics.